



Open Source India 2012 Takes FOSS to a New Level

The techie crowd at Asia's largest open source convention shows how FOSS has evolved from being a niche concept to becoming mainstream.

The future of technology lies in it being free and open source. This was the unanimous call raised by the participants and community members present at the event. FOSS is not just about making the source code of the software freely available; it's also about opening up of the mind. Open Source India (OSI) 2012 concluded on this positive note, promising to come back next year with much more power and increased involvement from the community.

The three-day affair proved to be an apt platform for a reunion of the FOSS community and for the sharing of FOSS concepts. The informative sessions and quality audience at Asia's largest open source convention proved how FOSS has evolved from being a niche concept to becoming mainstream.

The event witnessed a turnout of industry professionals, the community folk and a lot of newbies who came to get a closer look and to experience the FOSS environment. Open Source India 2012, which concluded at the NIMHANS Convention Center, Bengaluru, featured a lot of enlightening content.

Sharing his insight on OSI 2012, Ramesh Chopra, vice chairman, EFX Enterprises Pvt Ltd, said, "We are glad that we have been able to bring out a much bigger, better and improved OSI this year. We aimed at offering something for all techies, including software developers, IT managers and heads of IT departments, project managers, delivery experts, academia, and the open source community."

Praising the event, Dr Pramod K Varma, chief architect and technology advisor to the Unique Identification Authority of India, said, "India has become a huge consumer of open source technology. It's about time that we also became a dominant contributor to the open source projects. I think OSI, being a leading open source event in India, is proving to be a great platform for encouraging the community and increasing participation in open source projects."

The three-day convention witnessed the presence of over 70 speakers from the corporate world and the community. Companies like Oracle, Sify Technologies Limited, Intel, Acquia, HP, Dell and Microsoft came forward to show their support for open source technology at this event. Mandar Naik, director, Platform Strategy, Microsoft, said, "It is always exciting to be a part of OSI, and this year was no exception. The technology sessions were highly informative with some of the experts sharing their insights on a range of topics including mobile application development, the kernel and the cloud. I feel the conference proved to be a great opportunity to engage with technology enthusiasts from all over the country, ranging from app developers and open source contributors



The stage is set for the three-day 'open' convention



The event's registration desk is all set to welcome open source fans



The event witnessed the participation of many serious open source fans over the three days



(Left to Right) Varad Gupta, Dibya Prakash, Divyanshu, Prashanth Ranjalkar and Sanjay Manwani engaged in an exciting discussion on 'FOSS-fuelled Innovation' on Day 3